[5] "The staff belonging to the man I choose will sprout, and I will rid Myself of the constant grumbling of the Israelites against you." [6] So Moses spoke to the Israelites, and each of their leaders gave him a staff—one for each of the leaders of their tribes, twelve staffs in all. And Aaron's staff was among them. [7] Then Moses placed the staffs before the LORD in the Tent of the Testimony. [8] The next day Moses entered the Tent of the Testimony and saw that Aaron's staff, representing the house of Levi, had sprouted, put forth buds, blossomed, and produced almonds. [9] Then Moses brought out all the staffs from the LORD's presence to all the Israelites. They saw them, and each man took his own staff. [10] The LORD said to Moses, "Put Aaron's staff back in front of the Testimony, to be kept as a sign for the rebellious, so that you may put an end to their grumbling against Me, lest they die." [11] So Moses did as the LORD had commanded him. [12] Then the Israelites declared to Moses, "Look, we are perishing! We are lost; we are all lost!" [13] "Anyone who comes near the tabernacle of the LORD will die. Are we all going to perish?"

18 So the LORD said to Aaron, "You and your sons and your father's house must bear the iniquity involving the sanctuary. And you and your sons alone must bear the iniquity involving your priesthood." [2] But bring with you also your brothers from the tribe of Levi, the tribe of your father, that they may join you and assist you and your sons before the Tent of the Testimony. [3] And they shall attend to your duties and to all the duties of the Tent; but they must not come near to the furnishings of the sanctuary or the altar, or both they and you will die. [4] They are to join you and attend to the duties of the Tent of Meeting, doing all the work at the Tent; but no outsider may come near you. [5] And you shall attend to the duties of the sanctuary and of the altar, so that wrath may not fall on the Israelites again. [6] Behold, I Myself have selected your fellow Levites from the Israelites as a gift to you, dedicated to the LORD to perform the service for the Tent of Meeting. [7] "But only you and your sons shall attend to your priesthood for everything concerning the altar and what is inside the veil, and you are to perform that service. I am giving you the work of the priesthood as a gift, but any outsider who comes near the sanctuary must be put to death." [8] Then the LORD said to Aaron, "Behold, I have put you in charge of My offerings. As for all the sacred offerings of the Israelites, I have given them to you and your sons as a portion and a permanent statute." [9] A portion of the most holy offerings reserved from the fire will be yours. From all the offerings they render to Me as most holy offerings, whether grain offerings or sin offerings or guilt offerings, that part belongs to you and your sons.

[10] You are to eat it as a most holy offering, and every male may eat it. You shall regard it as holy. [11] And this is yours as well: the offering of their gifts, along with all the wave offerings of the Israelites. I have given this to you and your sons and daughters as a permanent statute. Every ceremonially clean person in your household may eat it. [12] I give you all the freshest olive oil and all the finest new wine and grain that the Israelites give to the LORD as their firstfruits. [13] The firstfruits of everything in their land that they bring to the LORD will belong to you. Every ceremonially clean person in your household may eat them.

[14] Every devoted thing in Israel belongs to you. [15] The firstborn of every womb, whether man or beast, that is offered to the LORD belongs to you. But you must surely redeem every firstborn son and every firstborn male of unclean animals. [16] You are to pay the redemption price for a month-old male according to your valuation: five shekels of silver, according to the sanctuary shekel, which is twenty gerahs. [17] But you must not redeem the firstborn of an ox, a sheep, or a goat; they are holy. You are to sprinkle their blood on the altar and burn their fat as an offering made by fire, a pleasing aroma to the LORD. [18] And their meat belongs to you, just as the breast and right thigh of the wave offering belong to you. [19] "All the holy offerings that the Israelites present to the LORD I give to you and to your sons and daughters as a permanent statute. It is a permanent covenant of salt before the LORD for you and your offspring." [20] Then the LORD said to Aaron, "You will have no inheritance in their land, nor will you have any portion among them. I am your portion and your inheritance among the Israelites."

[21] Behold, I have given to the Levites all the tithes in Israel as an inheritance in return for the work they do, the service of the Tent of Meeting. [22] No longer may the Israelites come near to the Tent of Meeting, or they will incur guilt and die. [23] The Levites are to perform the work of the Tent of Meeting, and they must bear their iniquity. This is a permanent statute for the generations to come. The Levites will not receive an inheritance among the Israelites. [24] "For I have given to the Levites as their inheritance the tithe that the Israelites present to the LORD as a contribution. That is why I told them that they would not receive an inheritance among the Israelites." [25] And the LORD instructed Moses, [26] "Speak to the Levites and tell them: 'When you receive from the Israelites the tithe that I have given you as your inheritance, you must present part of it as an offering to the LORD—a tithe of the tithe.'" [27] Your offering will be reckoned to you as grain from the threshing floor or juice from the winepress. [28] So you are to present an offering to the LORD from all the tithes you receive from the Israelites, and from these you are to give the LORD's offering to Aaron the priest. [29] You must present the offering due the LORD from all the best of every gift, the holiest part of it.' [30] Therefore say to the Levites, 'When you have presented the best part, it will be reckoned to you as the produce of the threshing floor or winepress.' [31] And you and your households may eat the rest of it anywhere; it is the compensation for your work at the Tent of Meeting. [32] "Once you have presented the best part of it, you will not incur guilt because of it. But you must not defile the sacred offerings of the Israelites, or else you will die.'"

19 Then the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, [2] "This is the statute of the law that the LORD has commanded: Instruct the Israelites to bring you an unblemished red heifer that has no defect and has never been placed under a yoke." [3] Give it to Eleazar the priest, and he will have it brought outside the camp and slaughtered in his presence. [4] Eleazar the priest is to take some of its blood on his finger and sprinkle it seven times toward the front of the Tent of Meeting. [5] Then the heifer must be burned in his sight. Its hide, its flesh, and its blood are to be burned, along with its dung. [6] The priest is to take cedar wood, hyssop, and scarlet wool and throw them onto the burning heifer.

[7] Then the priest must wash his clothes and bathe his body in water; after that he may enter the camp, but he will be ceremonially unclean until evening. [8] The one who burned the heifer must also wash his clothes and bathe his body in water, and he too will be ceremonially unclean until evening. [9] Then a man who is ceremonially clean is to gather up the ashes of the heifer and store them in a ceremonially clean place outside the camp. They must be kept by the congregation of Israel for preparing the water of purification; this is for purification from sin.

[10] The man who has gathered up the ashes of the heifer must also wash his clothes, and he will be ceremonially unclean until evening. This is a permanent statute for the Israelites and for the foreigner residing among them. [11] Whoever touches any dead body will be unclean for seven days. [12] He must purify himself with the water on the third day and on the seventh day; then he will be clean. But if he does not purify himself on the third and seventh days, he will not be clean. [13] Anyone who touches a human corpse and fails to purify himself defiles the tabernacle of the LORD. That person must be cut off from Israel. He remains unclean, because the water of purification has not been sprinkled on him, and his uncleanness is still on him.

[14] This is the law when a person dies in a tent: Everyone who enters the tent and everyone already in the tent will be unclean for seven days, [15] and any open container without a lid fastened on it is unclean. [16] Anyone in the open field who touches someone who has been killed by the sword or has died of natural causes, or anyone who touches a human bone or a grave, will be unclean for seven days. [17] For the purification of the unclean person, take some of the ashes of the burnt sin offering, put them in a jar, and pour fresh water over them. [18] Then a man who is ceremonially clean is to take some hyssop, dip it in the water, and sprinkle the tent, all the furnishings, and the people who were there. He is also to sprinkle the one who touched a bone, a grave, or a person who has died or been slain. [19] The man who is ceremonially clean is to sprinkle the unclean person on the third day and on the seventh day. After he purifies the unclean person on the seventh day, the one being cleansed must wash his clothes and bathe in water, and that evening he will be clean. [20] But if a person who is unclean does not purify himself, he will be cut off from the assembly, because he has defiled the sanctuary of the LORD. The water of purification has not been sprinkled on him; he is unclean. [21] This is a permanent statute for the people: The one who sprinkles the water of purification must wash his clothes, and whoever touches the water of purification will be unclean until evening. [22] "Anything the unclean person touches will become unclean, and anyone who touches it will be unclean until evening."

20 In the first month, the whole congregation of Israel entered the Wilderness of Zin and stayed in Kadesh. There Miriam died and was buried. [2] Now there was no water for the congregation, so they gathered against Moses and Aaron. [3] The people quarreled with Moses and said, "If only we had perished with our brothers before the LORD!" [4] Why have you brought the LORD's assembly into this wilderness for us and our livestock to die here? [5] "Why have you led us up out of Egypt to bring us to this wretched place? It is not a place of grain, figs, vines, or pomegranates—and there is no water to drink!" [6] Then Moses and Aaron went from the presence of the assembly to the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. They fell facedown, and the glory of the LORD appeared to them. [7] And the LORD said to Moses, [8] "Take the staff and assemble the congregation. You and your brother Aaron are to speak to the rock while they watch, and it will pour out its water. You will bring out water from the rock and provide drink for the congregation and their livestock."

[9] So Moses took the staff from the LORD's presence, just as he had been commanded. [10] Then Moses and Aaron gathered the assembly in front of the rock, and Moses said to them, "Listen now, you rebels, must we bring you water out of this rock?" [11] Then Moses raised his hand and struck the rock twice with his staff, so that a great amount of water gushed out, and the congregation and their livestock were able to drink. [12] But the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, "Because you did not trust Me to show My holiness in the sight of the Israelites, you will not bring this assembly into the land that I have given them."

[13] These were the waters of Meribah, where the Israelites quarreled with the LORD, and He showed His holiness among them. [14] From Kadesh, Moses sent messengers to tell the king of Edom, "This is what your brother Israel says: You know all the hardship that has befallen us," [15] how our fathers went down to Egypt, where we lived many years. The Egyptians mistreated us and our fathers, [16] and when we cried out to the LORD, He heard our voice, sent an angel, and brought us out of Egypt. Now look, we are in Kadesh, a city on the edge of

your territory. [17] "Please let us pass through your land. We will not cut through any field or vineyard, or drink water from any well. We will stay on the King's Highway; we will not turn to the right or to the left until we have passed through your territory." [18] But Edom answered, "You may not travel through our land, or we will come out and confront you with the sword."

[19] "We will stay on the main road," the Israelites replied, "and if we or our herds drink your water, we will pay for it. There will be no problem; only let us pass through on foot." [20] But Edom insisted, "You may not pass through." And they came out to confront the Israelites with a large army and a strong hand. [21] So Edom refused to allow Israel to pass through their territory, and Israel turned away from them. [22] After they had set out from Kadesh, the whole congregation of Israel came to Mount Hor. [23] And at Mount Hor, near the border of the land of Edom, the LORD said to Moses and Aaron, [24] "Aaron will be gathered to his people; he will not enter the land that I have given the Israelites, because both of you rebelled against My command at the waters of Meribah." [25] Take Aaron and his son Eleazar and bring them up Mount Hor. [26] "Remove Aaron's priestly garments and put them on his son Eleazar. Aaron will be gathered to his people and will die there." [27] So Moses did as the LORD had commanded, and they climbed Mount Hor in the sight of the whole congregation. [28] After Moses had removed Aaron's garments and put them on his son Eleazar, Aaron died there on top of the mountain. Then Moses and Eleazar came down from the mountain. [29] When the whole congregation saw that Aaron had died, the entire house of Israel mourned for him thirty days.

21 When the Canaanite king of Arad, who lived in the Negev, heard that Israel was coming along the road to Atharim, he attacked Israel and captured some prisoners. [2] So Israel made a vow to the LORD: "If You will deliver this people into our hands, we will devote their cities to destruction." [3] And the LORD heard Israel's plea and delivered up the Canaanites. Israel devoted them and their cities to destruction; so they named the place Hormah. [4] Then they set out from Mount Hor along the route to the Red Sea, in order to bypass the land of Edom. But the people grew impatient on the journey [5] and spoke against God and against Moses: "Why have you led us up out of Egypt to die in the wilderness? There is no bread or water, and we detest this wretched food!" [6] So the LORD sent venomous snakes among the people, and many of the Israelites were bitten and died. [7] Then the people came to Moses and said, "We have sinned by speaking against the LORD and against you. Intercede with the LORD so He will take the snakes away from us." So Moses interceded for the people. [8] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Make a fiery serpent and mount it on a pole. When anyone who is bitten looks at it, he will live." [9] So Moses made a bronze snake and mounted it on a pole. If anyone who was bitten looked at the bronze snake, he would live. [10] Then the Israelites set out and camped at Oboth.

[11] They journeyed from Oboth and camped at Iye-abarim in the wilderness opposite Moab to the east. [12] From there they set out and camped in the Valley of Zered. [13] From there they moved on and camped on the other side of the Arnon, in the wilderness that extends into the Amorite territory. Now the Arnon is the border between the Moabites and the Amorites. [14] Therefore it is stated in the Book of the Wars of the LORD: "Waheb in Suphah and the wadis of the Arnon," [15] "even the slopes of the wadis that extend to the site of Ar and lie along the border of Moab." [16] From there they went on to Beer, the well where the LORD said to Moses, "Gather the people so that I may give them water."

[17] Then Israel sang this song: "Spring up, O well, all of you sing to it!" [18] "The princes dug the well; the nobles of the people hollowed it out with their scepters and with their staffs." From the wilderness the Israelites went on to Mattanah, [19] and from Mattanah to Nahaliel, and from Nahaliel to Bamoth, [20] and from Bamoth to the valley in Moab where the top of Pisgah overlooks the wasteland. [21] Then Israel sent messengers to Sihon king of the Amorites, saying, [22] "Let us pass through your land. We will not cut through any field or vineyard, or drink water from any well. We will stay on the King's Highway until we have passed through your territory."

[23] But Sihon would not let Israel pass through his territory. Instead, he gathered his whole army and went out to confront Israel in the wilderness. When he came to Jahaz, he fought against Israel. [24] And Israel put him to the sword and took possession of his land, from the Arnon to the Jabbok—but only up to the border of the Ammonites, because it was fortified. [25] Israel captured all the cities of the Amorites and occupied them, including Heshbon and all its villages. [26] Heshbon was the city of Sihon king of the Amorites, who had fought against the former king of Moab and taken all his land as far as the Arnon. [27] That is why the poets say: "Come to Heshbon, let it be rebuilt; let the city of Sihon be restored." [28] For a fire went out from Heshbon, a blaze from the city of Sihon. It consumed Ar of Moab, the rulers of Arnon's heights. [29] Woe to you, O Moab! You are destroyed, O people of Chemosh! He gave up his sons as refugees, and his daughters into captivity to Sihon king of the Amorites. [30] "But we have overthrown them; Heshbon is destroyed as far as Dibon. We demolished them as far as Nophah, which reaches to Medeba." [31] So Israel lived in the land of the Amorites. [32] After Moses had sent spies to Jazer, Israel captured its villages and drove out the Amorites who were there. [33] Then they turned and went up the road to Bashan, and Og king of Bashan and his whole army came out to meet them in battle at Edrei. [34] But the LORD said to Moses, "Do not fear him, for I have delivered him into your hand, along with all his people and his land. Do to him as you did to Sihon king of the Amorites, who lived in Heshbon." [35] So they struck down Og, along with his sons and his whole army, until no remnant was left. And they took possession of his land.

22 Then the Israelites traveled on and camped in the plains of Moab near the Jordan, across from Jericho. [2] Now Balak son of Zippor saw all that Israel had done to the Amorites, [3] and Moab was terrified of the people because they were numerous. Indeed, Moab dreaded the Israelites. [4] So the Moabites said to the elders of Midian, "This horde will devour everything around us, as an ox licks up the grass of the field." Since Balak son of Zippor was king of Moab at that time, [5] he sent messengers to Balaam son of Beor at Pethor, which is by the Euphrates in the land of his people. "Behold, a people has come out of Egypt," said Balak. "They cover the face of the land and have settled next to me." [6] "So please come now and put a curse on this people, because they are too mighty for me. Perhaps I may be able to defeat them and drive them out of the land; for I know that those you bless are blessed, and those you curse are cursed." [7] The elders of Moab and Midian departed with the fees for divination in hand. They came to Balaam and relayed to him the words of Balak. [8] "Spend the night here," Balaam replied, "and I will give you the answer that the LORD speaks to me." So the princes of Moab stayed with Balaam. [9] Then God came to Balaam and asked, "Who are these men with you?" [10] And Balaam said to God, "Balak son of Zippor, king of Moab, sent me this message:" [11] "'Behold, a people has come out of Egypt, and they cover the face of the land. Now come and put a curse on them for me. Perhaps I may be able to fight against them and drive them away.'" [12] But God said to Balaam, "Do not go with them. You are not to curse this people, for they are blessed."

[13] So Balaam got up the next morning and said to Balak's princes, "Go back to your homeland, because the LORD has refused to let me go with you." [14] And the princes of Moab arose, returned to Balak, and said, "Balaam refused to come with us." [15] Then Balak sent other princes, more numerous and more distinguished than the first messengers. [16] They came to Balaam and said, "This is what Balak son of Zippor says: 'Please let nothing hinder you from coming to me,'" [17] "for I will honor you richly and do whatever you say. So please come and put a curse on this people for me!'" [18] But Balaam replied to the servants of Balak, "If Balak were to give me his house full of silver and gold, I could not do anything small or great to go beyond the command of the LORD my God." [19] "So now, please stay here overnight as the others did, that I may find out what else the LORD has to tell me." [20] That night God came to Balaam and said, "Since these men have come to summon you, get up and go with them, but you must only do what I tell you."

[21] So in the morning Balaam got up, saddled his donkey, and went with the princes of Moab. [22] Then God's anger was kindled because Balaam was going along, and the angel of the LORD stood in the road to oppose him. Balaam was riding his donkey, and his two servants were with him. [23] When the donkey saw the angel of the LORD standing in the road with a drawn sword in his hand, she turned off the path and went into a field. So Balaam beat her to return her to the path. [24] Then the angel of the LORD stood in a narrow passage between two vineyards, with walls on either side. [25] And the donkey saw the angel of the LORD and pressed herself against the wall, crushing Balaam's foot against it. So he beat her once again. [26] And the angel of the LORD moved on ahead and stood in a narrow place where there was no room to turn to the right or left.

[27] When the donkey saw the angel of the LORD, she lay down under Balaam, and he became furious and beat her with his staff. [28] Then the LORD opened the donkey's mouth, and she said to Balaam, "What have I done to you that you have beaten me these three times?" [29] Balaam answered the donkey, "You have made a fool of me! If I had a sword in my hand, I would kill you right now!" [30] But the donkey said to Balaam, "Am I not the donkey you have ridden all your life until today? Have I ever treated you this way before?" "No," he replied. [31] Then the LORD opened Balaam's eyes, and he saw the angel of the LORD standing in the road with a drawn sword in his hand. And Balaam bowed low and fell facedown. [32] The angel of the LORD asked him, "Why have you beaten your donkey these three times? Behold, I have come out to oppose you, because your way is perverse before me." [33] "The donkey saw me and turned away from me these three times. If she had not turned away, then by now I would surely have killed you and let her live." [34] "I have sinned," Balaam said to the angel of the LORD, "for I did not realize that you were standing in the road to confront me. And now, if this is displeasing in your sight, I will go back home." [35] But the angel of the LORD said to Balaam, "Go with the men, but you are to speak only what I tell you." So Balaam went with the princes of Balak. [36] When Balak heard that Balaam was coming, he went out to meet him at the Moabite city on the Arnon border, at the edge of his territory. [37] And he said to Balaam, "Did I not send you an urgent summons? Why did you not come to me? Am I really not able to richly reward you?" [38] "See, I have come to you," Balaam replied, "but can I say just anything? I must speak only the word that God puts in my mouth." [39] So Balaam accompanied Balak, and they came to Kiriath-huzoth. [40] Balak sacrificed cattle and sheep, and he gave portions to Balaam and the princes who were with him. [41] The next morning, Balak took Balaam and brought him up to Bamoth-baal. From there he could see the outskirts of the camp of the people.

23 Then Balaam said to Balak, "Build for me seven altars here, and prepare for me seven bulls and seven rams." [2] So Balak did as Balaam had instructed, and Balak and Balaam offered a bull and a ram on each altar. [3] "Stay here by your burnt offering while I am gone," Balaam said to Balak. "Perhaps the LORD will meet with me. And whatever He reveals to me, I will tell you." So Balaam went off

to a barren height, [4] and God met with him. "I have set up seven altars," Balaam said, "and on each altar I have offered a bull and a ram." [5] Then the LORD put a message in Balaam's mouth, saying, "Return to Balak and give him this message." [6] So he returned to Balak, who was standing there beside his burnt offering, with all the princes of Moab. [7] And Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying: "Balak brought me from Aram, the king of Moab from the mountains of the east. 'Come,' he said, 'put a curse on Jacob for me; come and denounce Israel!'" [8] How can I curse what God has not cursed? How can I denounce what the LORD has not denounced? [9] For I see them from atop the rocky cliffs, and I watch them from the hills. Behold, a people dwelling apart, not reckoning themselves among the nations.

[10] "Who can count the dust of Jacob or number even a fourth of Israel? Let me die the death of the righteous; let my end be like theirs!" [11] Then Balak said to Balaam, "What have you done to me? I brought you here to curse my enemies, and behold, you have only blessed them!" [12] But Balaam replied, "Should I not speak exactly what the LORD puts in my mouth?"

[13] Then Balak said to him, "Please come with me to another place where you can see them. You will only see the outskirts of their camp—not all of them. And from there, curse them for me." [14] So Balak took him to the field of Zophim, to the top of Pisgah, where he built seven altars and offered a bull and a ram on each altar. [15] Balaam said to Balak, "Stay here beside your burnt offering while I meet the LORD over there." [16] And the LORD met with Balaam and put a message in his mouth, saying, "Return to Balak and speak what I tell you." [17] So he returned to Balak, who was standing there by his burnt offering with the princes of Moab. "What did the LORD say?" Balak asked. [18] Then Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying: "Arise, O Balak, and listen; give ear to me, O son of Zippor." [19] God is not a man, that He should lie, or a son of man, that He should change His mind. Does He speak and not act? Does He promise and not fulfill?

[20] I have indeed received a command to bless; He has blessed, and I cannot change it. [21] He considers no disaster for Jacob; He sees no trouble for Israel. The LORD their God is with them, and the shout of the King is among them. [22] God brought them out of Egypt with strength like a wild ox. [23] For there is no spell against Jacob and no divination against Israel. It will now be said of Jacob and Israel, 'What great things God has done!' [24] "Behold, the people rise like a lioness; they rouse themselves like a lion, not resting until they devour their prey and drink the blood of the slain." [25] Now Balak said to Balaam, "Then neither curse them at all nor bless them at all!" [26] But Balaam replied, "Did I not tell you that whatever the LORD says, I must do?" [27] "Please come," said Balak, "I will take you to another place. Perhaps it will please God that you curse them for me from there." [28] And Balak took Balaam to the top of Peor, which overlooks the wasteland. [29] Then Balaam said, "Build for me seven altars here, and prepare for me seven bulls and seven rams." [30] So Balak did as Balaam had instructed, and he offered a bull and a ram on each altar.

24 And when Balaam saw that it pleased the LORD to bless Israel, he did not resort to sorcery as on previous occasions, but he turned his face toward the wilderness. [2] When Balaam looked up and saw Israel encamped tribe by tribe, the Spirit of God came upon him, [3] and he lifted up an oracle, saying: "This is the prophecy of Balaam son of Beor, the prophecy of a man whose eyes are open," [4] the prophecy of one who hears the words of God, who sees a vision from the Almighty, who bows down with eyes wide open: [5] How lovely are your tents, O Jacob, your dwellings, O Israel! [6] They spread out like palm groves, like gardens beside a stream, like aloes the LORD has planted, like cedars beside the waters. [7] Water will flow from his buckets, and his seed will have abundant water. His king will be greater than Agag, and his kingdom will be exalted.

[8] God brought him out of Egypt with strength like a wild ox, to devour hostile nations and crush their bones, to pierce them with arrows. [9] "He crouches, he lies down like a lion; like a lioness, who dares to rouse him? Blessed are those who bless you and cursed are those who curse you." [10] Then Balak's anger burned against Balaam, and he struck his hands together and said to Balaam, "I summoned you to curse my enemies, but behold, you have persisted in blessing them these three times." [11] "Therefore, flee at once to your home! I said I would richly reward you, but instead the LORD has denied your reward." [12] Balaam answered Balak, "Did I not already tell the messengers you sent me" [13] that even if Balak were to give me his house full of silver and gold, I could not do anything of my own accord, good or bad, to go beyond the command of the LORD? I will speak whatever the LORD says.

[14] "Now I am going back to my people, but come, let me warn you what this people will do to your people in the days to come." [15] Then Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying, "This is the prophecy of Balaam son of Beor, the prophecy of a man whose eyes are open," [16] the prophecy of one who hears the words of God, who has knowledge from the Most High, who sees a vision from the Almighty, who bows down with eyes wide open: [17] I see him, but not now; I behold him, but not near. A star will come forth from Jacob, and a scepter will arise from Israel. He will crush the skulls of Moab and strike down all the sons of Sheth. [18] Edom will become a possession, as will Seir, his enemy; but Israel will perform with valor. [19] "A ruler will come from Jacob and destroy the survivors of the city." [20] Then Balaam saw Amalek and lifted up an oracle, saying: "Amalek was first among the nations, but his end is destruction." [21] Next he saw the Kenites and lifted up an oracle, saying: "Your dwelling place is secure, and your nest is set in a cliff." [22] "Yet Kain will be destroyed when Asshur takes you captive." [23] Once more Balaam lifted up an oracle, saying: "Ah, who can live unless God has ordained it?" [24] "Ships will come from the coasts of Cyprus; they will subdue Asshur and Eber, but they too will perish forever." [25] Then Balaam arose and returned to his homeland, and Balak also went on his way.

25 While Israel was staying in Shittim, the men began to indulge in sexual immorality with the daughters of Moab, [2] who also invited them to the sacrifices for their gods. And the people ate and bowed down to these gods. [3] So Israel joined in worshiping Baal of Peor, and the anger of the LORD burned against them. [4] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Take all the leaders of the people and execute them in broad daylight before the LORD, so that His fierce anger may turn away from Israel." [5] So Moses told the judges of Israel, "Each of you must kill all of his men who have joined in worshiping Baal of Peor." [6] Just then an Israelite man brought to his family a Midianite woman in the sight of Moses and the whole congregation of Israel while they were weeping at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. [7] On seeing this, Phinehas son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, got up from the assembly, took a spear in his hand, [8] followed the Israelite into his tent, and drove the spear through both of them—through the Israelite and on through the belly of the woman. So the plague against the Israelites was halted, [9] but those who died in the plague numbered 24,000.

[10] Then the LORD said to Moses, [11] "Phinehas son of Eleazar, the son of Aaron the priest, has turned My wrath away from the Israelites; for he was zealous for My sake among them, so that I did not consume the Israelites in My zeal." [12] Declare, therefore, that I am granting him My covenant of peace. [13] "It will be a covenant of permanent priesthood for him and his descendants, because he was zealous for his God and made atonement for the Israelites." [14] The name of the Israelite who was slain with the Midianite woman was Zimri son of Salu, the leader of a Simeonite family. [15] And the name of the slain Midianite woman was Cozbi, the daughter of Zur, a tribal chief of a Midianite family. [16] And the LORD said to Moses, [17] "Attack the Midianites and strike them dead." [18] "For they assailed you deceitfully when they seduced you in the matter of Peor and their sister Cozbi, the daughter of the Midianite leader, the woman who was killed on the day the plague came because of Peor."

26 After the plague had ended, the LORD said to Moses and Eleazar son of Aaron the priest, [2] "Take a census of the whole congregation of Israel by the houses of their fathers—all those twenty years of age or older who can serve in the army of Israel." [3] So on the plains of Moab by the Jordan, across from Jericho, Moses and Eleazar the priest issued the instruction, [4] "Take a census of the men twenty years of age or older, as the LORD has commanded Moses." And these were the Israelites who came out of the land of Egypt:

[5] Reuben was the firstborn of Israel. These were the descendants of Reuben: The Hanochite clan from Hanoch, the Palluite clan from Pallu,

[6] the Hezronite clan from Hezron, and the Carmite clan from Carmi.

[7] These were the clans of Reuben, and their registration numbered 43,730.

[8] Now the son of Pallu was Eliab,

[9] and the sons of Eliab were Nemuel, Dathan, and Abiram. It was Dathan and Abiram, chosen by the congregation, who fought against Moses and Aaron with the followers of Korah who rebelled against the LORD.

[10] And the earth opened its mouth and swallowed them along with Korah, whose followers died when the fire consumed 250 men. They serve as a warning sign.

[11] However, the line of Korah did not die out.

[12] These were the descendants of Simeon by their clans: The Nemuelite clan from Nemuel, the Jaminite clan from Jamin, the Jachinite clan from Jachin,

[13] the Zerahite clan from Zerah, and the Shaulite clan from Shaul.

[14] These were the clans of Simeon, and there were 22,200 men.

[15] These were the descendants of Gad by their clans: The Zephonite clan from Zephon, the Haggite clan from Haggi, the Shunite clan from Shuni,

[16] the Oznite clan from Ozni, the Erite clan from Eri,

[17] the Arodite clan from Arod, and the Arelite clan from Areli.

[18] These were the clans of Gad, and their registration numbered 40,500.

[19] The sons of Judah were Er and Onan, but they died in the land of Canaan.

[20] These were the descendants of Judah by their clans: The Shelanite clan from Shelah, the Perezite clan from Perez, and the Zerahite clan from Zerah.

[21] And these were the descendants of Perez: the Hezronite clan from Hezron and the Hamulite clan from Hamul.

[22] These were the clans of Judah, and their registration numbered 76,500.

[23] These were the descendants of Issachar by their clans: The Tolaite clan from Tola, the Punite clan from Puvah,

[24] the Jashubite clan from Jashub, and the Shimronite clan from Shimron.

[25] These were the clans of Issachar, and their registration numbered 64,300.

[26] These were the descendants of Zebulun by their clans: The Seredite clan from Sered, the Elonite clan from Elon, and the Jahleelite clan from Jahleel.

[27] These were the clans of Zebulun, and their registration numbered 60,500.

[28] The descendants of Joseph included the clans of Manasseh and Ephraim.

[29] These were the descendants of Manasseh: The Machirite clan from Machir, the father of Gilead, and the Gileadite clan from Gilead.

[30] These were the descendants of Gilead: the Iezerite clan from Iezer, the Helekite clan from Helek,

[31] the Asrielite clan from Asriel, the Shechemite clan from Shechem,

[32] the Shemidaite clan from Shemida, and the Hepherite clan from Hepher.
[33] Now Zelophehad son of Hepher had no sons but only daughters. The names of his daughters were Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.
[34] These were the clans of Manasseh, and their registration numbered 52,700.
[35] These were the descendants of Ephraim by their clans: The Shuthelahite clan from Shuthelah, the Becherite clan from Becher, and the Tahanite clan from Tahan.
[36] And the descendants of Shuthelah were the Eranite clan from Eran.
[37] These were the clans of Ephraim, and their registration numbered 32,500. These clans were the descendants of Joseph.
[38] These were the descendants of Benjamin by their clans: The Belaite clan from Bela, the Ashbelite clan from Ashbel, the Ahiramite clan from Ahiram,
[39] the Shuphamite clan from Shupham, and the Huphamite clan from Hupham.
[40] And the descendants of Bela from Ard and Naaman were the Ardite clan from Ard and the Naamite clan from Naaman.
[41] These were the clans of Benjamin, and their registration numbered 45,600.
[42] These were the descendants of Dan by their clans: The Shuhamite clan from Shuham. These were the clans of Dan.
[43] All of them were Shuhamite clans, and their registration numbered 64,400.
[44] These were the descendants of Asher by their clans: The Imnite clan from Imnah, the Ishvite clan from Ishvi, and the Beriite clan from Beriah.
[45] And these were the descendants of Beriah: the Heberite clan from Heber and the Malchielite clan from Malchiel.
[46] And the name of Asher's daughter was Serah.
[47] These were the clans of Asher, and their registration numbered 53,400.
[48] These were the descendants of Naphtali by their clans: The Jahzeelite clan from Jahzeel, the Gunite clan from Guni,
[49] the Jezerite clan from Jezer, and the Shillemite clan from Shillem.
[50] These were the clans of Naphtali, and their registration numbered 45,400.
[51] These men of Israel numbered 601,730 in all.
[52] Then the LORD said to Moses,
[53] "The land is to be divided among the tribes as an inheritance, according to the number of names."
[54] Increase the inheritance for a large tribe and decrease it for a small one; each tribe is to receive its inheritance according to the number of those registered.
[55] Indeed, the land must be divided by lot; they shall receive their inheritance according to the names of the tribes of their fathers.
[56] "Each inheritance is to be divided by lot among the larger and smaller tribes."
[57] Now these were the Levites numbered by their clans: The Gershonite clan from Gershon, the Kohathite clan from Kohath, and the Merarite clan from Merari.
[58] These were the families of the Levites: The Libnite clan, the Hebronite clan, the Mahlite clan, the Mushite clan, and the Korahite clan. Now Kohath was the father of Amram,
[59] and Amram's wife was named Jochebed. She was also a daughter of Levi, born to Levi in Egypt. To Amram she bore Aaron, Moses, and their sister Miriam.
[60] Nadab, Abihu, Eleazar, and Ithamar were born to Aaron,
[61] but Nadab and Abihu died when they offered unauthorized fire before the LORD.
[62] The registration of the Levites totaled 23,000, every male a month old or more; they were not numbered among the other Israelites, because no inheritance was given to them among the Israelites. [63] These were the ones numbered by Moses and Eleazar the priest when they counted the Israelites on the plains of Moab by the Jordan, across from Jericho. [64] Among all these, however, there was not one who had been numbered by Moses and Aaron the priest when they counted the Israelites in the Wilderness of Sinai. [65] For the LORD had told them that they would surely die in the wilderness. Not one was left except Caleb son of Jephunneh and Joshua son of Nun.

27 Now the daughters of Zelophehad son of Hepher, the son of Gilead, the son of Machir, the son of Manasseh, belonged to the clans of Manasseh son of Joseph. These were the names of his daughters: Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah. They approached [2] the entrance to the Tent of Meeting, stood before Moses, Eleazar the priest, the leaders, and the whole congregation, and said, [3] "Our father died in the wilderness, but he was not among the followers of Korah who gathered together against the LORD. Instead, he died because of his own sin, and he had no sons." [4] "Why should the name of our father disappear from his clan because he had no sons? Give us property among our father's brothers." [5] So Moses brought their case before the LORD, [6] and the LORD answered him, [7] "The daughters of Zelophehad speak correctly. You certainly must give them property as an inheritance among their father's brothers, and transfer their father's inheritance to them." [8] Furthermore, you shall say to the Israelites, 'If a man dies and leaves no son, you are to transfer his inheritance to his daughter.' [9] If he has no daughter, give his inheritance to his brothers. [10] If he has no brothers, give his inheritance to his father's brothers. [11] "And if his father has no brothers, give his inheritance to the next of kin from his clan, that he may take possession of it. This is to be a statutory ordinance for the Israelites, as the LORD has commanded Moses.'" [12] Then the LORD said to Moses, "Go up this mountain of the Abarim range and see the land that I have given the Israelites." [13] After you have seen it, you too will be gathered to your people, as your brother Aaron was; [14] "for when the congregation contended in the Wilderness of Zin, both of you rebelled against My command to show My holiness in their sight regarding the waters." Those were the waters of Meribah in Kadesh, in the Wilderness of Zin.
[15] So Moses appealed to the LORD, [16] "May the LORD, the God of the spirits of all flesh, appoint a man over the congregation" [17] "who will go out and come in before them, and who will lead them out and bring them in, so that the congregation of the LORD will not be like sheep without a shepherd." [18] And the LORD replied to Moses, "Take Joshua son of Nun, a man with the Spirit in him, and lay your hands on him." [19] Have him stand before Eleazar the priest and the whole congregation, and commission him in their sight. [20] Confer on him some of your authority, so that the whole congregation of Israel will obey him. [21] "He shall stand before Eleazar the priest, who will seek counsel for him before the LORD by the judgment of the Urim. At his command, he and all the Israelites with him—the entire congregation—will go out and come in." [22] Moses did as the LORD had commanded him. He took Joshua, had him stand before Eleazar the priest and the whole congregation, [23] and laid his hands on him and commissioned him, as the LORD had instructed through Moses.

28 Then the LORD said to Moses, [2] "Command the Israelites and say to them: See that you present to Me at its appointed time the food for My offerings by fire, as a pleasing aroma to Me." [3] And tell them that this is the offering made by fire you are to present to the LORD as a regular burnt offering each day: two unblemished year-old male lambs. [4] Offer one lamb in the morning and the other at twilight, [5] along with a tenth of an ephah of fine flour as a grain offering, mixed with a quarter hin of oil from pressed olives. [6] This is a regular burnt offering established at Mount Sinai as a pleasing aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD. [7] The drink offering accompanying each lamb shall be a quarter hin. Pour out the offering of fermented drink to the LORD in the sanctuary area. [8] And offer the second lamb at twilight, with the same grain offering and drink offering as in the morning. It is an offering made by fire, a pleasing aroma to the LORD. [9] On the Sabbath day, present two unblemished year-old male lambs, accompanied by a grain offering of two-tenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil, as well as a drink offering.
[10] This is the burnt offering for every Sabbath, in addition to the regular burnt offering and its drink offering. [11] At the beginning of every month, you are to present to the LORD a burnt offering of two young bulls, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [12] along with three-tenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil as a grain offering with each bull, two-tenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil as a grain offering with the ram, [13] and a tenth of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil as a grain offering with each lamb. This is a burnt offering, a pleasing aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD.

[14] Their drink offerings shall be half a hin of wine with each bull, a third of a hin with the ram, and a quarter hin with each lamb. This is the monthly burnt offering to be made at each new moon throughout the year. [15] In addition to the regular burnt offering with its drink offering, one male goat is to be presented to the LORD as a sin offering. [16] The fourteenth day of the first month is the LORD's Passover. [17] On the fifteenth day of this month, there shall be a feast; for seven days unleavened bread is to be eaten. [18] On the first day there is to be a sacred assembly; you must not do any regular work. [19] Present to the LORD an offering made by fire, a burnt offering of two young bulls, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old, all unblemished.

[20] The grain offering shall consist of fine flour mixed with oil; offer three-tenths of an ephah with each bull, two-tenths of an ephah with the ram, [21] and a tenth of an ephah with each of the seven lambs. [22] Include one male goat as a sin offering to make atonement for you. [23] You are to present these in addition to the regular morning burnt offering. [24] Offer the same food each day for seven days as an offering made by fire, a pleasing aroma to the LORD. It is to be offered with its drink offering and the regular burnt offering. [25] On the seventh day you shall hold a sacred assembly; you must not do any regular work. [26] On the day of firstfruits, when you present an offering of new grain to the LORD during the Feast of Weeks, you are to hold a sacred assembly; you must not do any regular work. [27] Present a burnt offering of two young bulls, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old as a pleasing aroma to the LORD, [28] together with their grain offerings of fine flour mixed with oil—three-tenths of an ephah with each bull, two-tenths of an ephah with the ram, [29] and a tenth of an ephah with each of the seven lambs. [30] Include one male goat to make atonement for you. [31] Offer them with their drink offerings in addition to the regular burnt offering and its grain offering. The animals must be unblemished.

29 "On the first day of the seventh month, you are to hold a sacred assembly, and you must not do any regular work. This will be a day for you to sound the trumpets." [2] As a pleasing aroma to the LORD, you are to present a burnt offering of one young bull, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [3] together with their grain offerings of fine flour mixed with oil —three-tenths of an ephah with the bull, two-tenths of an ephah with the ram, [4] and a tenth of an ephah with each of the seven male lambs. [5] Include one male goat as a sin offering to make atonement for you. [6] These are in addition to the monthly and daily burnt offerings with their prescribed grain offerings and drink offerings. They are a pleasing aroma, an offering made by fire to the LORD. [7] On the tenth day of this seventh month, you are to hold a sacred assembly, and you

shall humble yourselves; you must not do any work. [8] Present as a pleasing aroma to the LORD a burnt offering of one young bull, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [9] together with their grain offerings of fine flour mixed with oil—three-tenths of an ephah with the bull, two-tenths of an ephah with the ram, [10] and a tenth of an ephah with each of the seven lambs. [11] Include one male goat for a sin offering, in addition to the sin offering of atonement and the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offerings. [12] On the fifteenth day of the seventh month, you are to hold a sacred assembly; you must not do any regular work, and you shall observe a feast to the LORD for seven days.

[13] As a pleasing aroma to the LORD, you are to present an offering made by fire, a burnt offering of thirteen young bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [14] along with the grain offering of three-tenths of an ephah of fine flour mixed with oil with each of the thirteen bulls, two-tenths of an ephah with each of the two rams, [15] and a tenth of an ephah with each of the fourteen lambs. [16] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering. [17] On the second day you are to present twelve young bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [18] along with the grain and drink offerings for the bulls, rams, and lambs, according to the number prescribed. [19] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering.

[20] On the third day you are to present eleven bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [21] along with the grain and drink offerings for the bulls, rams, and lambs, according to the number prescribed. [22] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering. [23] On the fourth day you are to present ten bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [24] along with the grain and drink offerings for the bulls, rams, and lambs, according to the number prescribed. [25] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering.

[26] On the fifth day you are to present nine bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [27] along with the grain and drink offerings for the bulls, rams, and lambs, according to the number prescribed. [28] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering. [29] On the sixth day you are to present eight bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [30] along with the grain and drink offerings for the bulls, rams, and lambs, according to the number prescribed. [31] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering. [32] On the seventh day you are to present seven bulls, two rams, and fourteen male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [33] along with the grain and drink offerings for the bulls, rams, and lambs, according to the number prescribed. [34] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering. [35] On the eighth day you are to hold a solemn assembly; you must not do any regular work. [36] As a pleasing aroma to the LORD, you are to present an offering made by fire, a burnt offering of one bull, one ram, and seven male lambs a year old, all unblemished, [37] along with the grain and drink offerings for the bulls, rams, and lambs, according to the number prescribed. [38] Include one male goat as a sin offering, in addition to the regular burnt offering with its grain offering and drink offering. [39] "You are to present these offerings to the LORD at your appointed times, in addition to your vow and freewill offerings, whether burnt offerings, grain offerings, drink offerings, or peace offerings." [40] So Moses spoke all this to the Israelites just as the LORD had commanded him.

30 Then Moses said to the heads of the tribes of Israel, "This is what the LORD has commanded:" [2] If a man makes a vow to the LORD or swears an oath to obligate himself by a pledge, he must not break his word; he must do everything he has promised. [3] And if a woman in her father's house during her youth makes a vow to the LORD or obligates herself by a pledge, [4] and her father hears about her vow or pledge but says nothing to her, then all the vows or pledges by which she has bound herself shall stand. [5] But if her father prohibits her on the day he hears about it, then none of the vows or pledges by which she has bound herself shall stand. The LORD will absolve her because her father has prohibited her. [6] If a woman marries while under a vow or rash promise by which she has bound herself, [7] and her husband hears of it but says nothing to her on that day, then the vows or pledges by which she has bound herself shall stand. [8] But if her husband prohibits her when he hears of it, he nullifies the vow that binds her or the rash promise she has made, and the LORD will absolve her.

[9] Every vow a widow or divorced woman pledges to fulfill is binding on her. [10] If a woman in her husband's house has made a vow or put herself under an obligation with an oath, [11] and her husband hears of it but says nothing to her and does not prohibit her, then all the vows or pledges by which she has bound herself shall stand. [12] But if her husband nullifies them on the day he hears of them, then nothing that came from her lips, whether her vows or pledges, shall stand. Her husband has nullified them, and the LORD will absolve her. [13] Her husband may confirm or nullify any vow or any sworn pledge to deny herself. [14] But if her husband says nothing to her from day to day, then he confirms all the vows and pledges that bind her. He has confirmed them, because he said nothing to her on the day he heard about them. [15] "But if he nullifies them after he hears of them, then he will bear her iniquity." [16] These are the statutes that the LORD commanded Moses concerning the relationship between a man and his wife, and between a father and a young daughter still in his home.

31 And the LORD said to Moses, [2] "Take vengeance on the Midianites for the Israelites. After that, you will be gathered to your people." [3] So Moses told the people, "Arm some of your men for war, that they may go against the Midianites and execute the LORD's vengeance on them." [4] "Send into battle a thousand men from each tribe of Israel." [5] So a thousand men were recruited from each tribe of Israel—twelve thousand armed for war. [6] And Moses sent the thousand from each tribe into battle, along with Phinehas son of Eleazar the priest, who took with him the vessels of the sanctuary and the trumpets for signaling. [7] Then they waged war against Midian, as the LORD had commanded Moses, and they killed every male. [8] Among the slain were Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba—the five kings of Midian. They also killed Balaam son of Beor with the sword. [9] The Israelites captured the Midianite women and their children, and they plundered all their herds, flocks, and goods. [10] Then they burned all the cities where the Midianites had lived, as well as all their encampments, [11] and carried away all the plunder and spoils, both people and animals. [12] They brought the captives, spoils, and plunder to Moses, to Eleazar the priest, and to the congregation of Israel at the camp on the plains of Moab, by the Jordan across from Jericho. [13] And Moses, Eleazar the priest, and all the leaders of the congregation went to meet them outside the camp. [14] But Moses was angry with the officers of the army—the commanders of thousands and commanders of hundreds—who were returning from the battle. [15] "Have you spared all the women?" he asked them. [16] "Look, these women caused the sons of Israel, through the counsel of Balaam, to turn unfaithfully against the LORD at Peor, so that the plague struck the congregation of the LORD." [17] So now, kill all the boys, as well as every woman who has had relations with a man, [18] but spare for yourselves every girl who has never had relations with a man. [19] All of you who have killed a person or touched the dead are to remain outside the camp for seven days. On the third day and the seventh day you are to purify both yourselves and your captives. [20] "And purify every garment and leather good, everything made of goat's hair, and every article of wood." [21] Then Eleazar the priest said to the soldiers who had gone into battle, "This is the statute of the law which the LORD has commanded Moses:" [22] Only the gold, silver, bronze, iron, tin, and lead— [23] everything that can withstand the fire—must be put through the fire, and it will be clean. But it must still be purified with the water of purification. And everything that cannot withstand the fire must pass through the water.

[24] "On the seventh day you are to wash your clothes, and you will be clean. After that you may enter the camp." [25] The LORD said to Moses, [26] "You and Eleazar the priest and the family heads of the congregation are to take a count of what was captured, both of man and beast." [27] Then divide the captives between the troops who went out to battle and the rest of the congregation. [28] Set aside a tribute for the LORD from what belongs to the soldiers who went into battle: one out of every five hundred, whether persons, cattle, donkeys, or sheep. [29] Take it from their half and give it to Eleazar the priest as an offering to the LORD. [30] "From the Israelites' half, take one out of every fifty, whether persons, cattle, donkeys, sheep, or other animals, and give them to the Levites who keep charge of the tabernacle of the LORD." [31] So Moses and Eleazar the priest did as the LORD had commanded Moses, [32] and this plunder remained from the spoils the soldiers had taken: 675,000 sheep, [33] 72,000 cattle, [34] 61,000 donkeys, [35] and 32,000 women who had not slept with a man.

[36] This was the half portion for those who had gone to war: [37] 337,500 sheep, including a tribute to the LORD of 675, [38] 36,000 cattle, including a tribute to the LORD of 72, [39] 30,500 donkeys, including a tribute to the LORD of 61, [40] and 16,000 people, including a tribute to the LORD of 32. [41] Moses gave the tribute to Eleazar the priest as an offering for the LORD, as the LORD had commanded Moses. [42] From the Israelites' half, which Moses had set apart from the men who had gone to war, [43] this half belonged to the congregation: 337,500 sheep, [44] 36,000 cattle, [45] 30,500 donkeys, [46] and 16,000 people. [47] From the Israelites' half, Moses took one out of every fifty persons and animals and gave them to the Levites who kept charge of the tabernacle of the LORD, as the LORD had commanded him. [48] Then the officers who were over the units of the army—the commanders of thousands and of hundreds—approached Moses [49] and said, "Your servants have counted the soldiers under our command, and not one of us is missing." [50] "So we have brought to the LORD an offering of the gold articles each man acquired—armlets, bracelets, rings, earrings, and necklaces—to make atonement for ourselves before the LORD." [51] So Moses and Eleazar the priest received from them all the articles made out of gold. [52] All the gold that the commanders of thousands and of hundreds presented as an offering to the LORD weighed 16,750 shekels. [53] Each of the soldiers had taken plunder for himself. [54] And Moses and Eleazar the priest received the gold from the commanders of thousands and of hundreds and brought it into the Tent of Meeting as a memorial for the Israelites before the LORD.

32 Now the Reubenites and Gadites, who had very large herds and flocks, surveyed the lands of Jazer and Gilead, and they saw that the region was suitable for livestock. [2] So the Gadites and Reubenites came to Moses, Eleazar the priest, and the leaders of the congregation, and said, [3] "Ataroth, Dibon, Jazer, Nimrah, Heshbon, Elealeh, Sebam, Nebo, and Beon," [4] "which the LORD conquered before the congregation of Israel, are suitable for livestock—and your servants

have livestock." [5] "If we have found favor in your sight," they said, "let this land be given to your servants as a possession. Do not make us cross the Jordan." [6] But Moses asked the Gadites and Reubenites, "Shall your brothers go to war while you sit here?" [7] Why are you discouraging the Israelites from crossing into the land that the LORD has given them? [8] This is what your fathers did when I sent them from Kadesh-barnea to inspect the land. [9] For when your fathers went up to the Valley of Eshcol and saw the land, they discouraged the Israelites from entering the land that the LORD had given them. [10] So the anger of the LORD was kindled that day, and He swore an oath, saying, [11] 'Because they did not follow Me wholeheartedly, not one of the men twenty years of age or older who came out of Egypt will see the land that I swore to give Abraham, Isaac, and Jacob —' [12] not one except Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite and Joshua son of Nun—because they did follow the LORD wholeheartedly.' [13] The anger of the LORD burned against Israel, and He made them wander in the wilderness forty years, until the whole generation who had done evil in His sight was gone.

[14] Now behold, you, a brood of sinners, have risen up in place of your fathers to further stoke the burning anger of the LORD against Israel. [15] "For if you turn away from following Him, He will once again leave this people in the wilderness, and you will be the cause of their destruction." [16] Then the Gadites and Reubenites approached Moses and said, "We want to build sheepfolds here for our livestock and cities for our little ones." [17] But we will arm ourselves and be ready to go ahead of the Israelites until we have brought them into their place. Meanwhile, our little ones will remain in the fortified cities for protection from the inhabitants of the land. [18] We will not return to our homes until every Israelite has taken possession of his inheritance. [19] "Yet we will not have an inheritance with them across the Jordan and beyond, because our inheritance has come to us on the east side of the Jordan."

[20] Moses replied, "If you will do this—if you will arm yourselves before the LORD for battle," [21] and if every one of your armed men crosses the Jordan before the LORD, until He has driven His enemies out before Him, [22] then when the land is subdued before the LORD, you may return and be free of obligation to the LORD and to Israel. And this land will belong to you as a possession before the LORD. [23] But if you do not do this, you will certainly sin against the LORD—and be assured that your sin will find you out. [24] "Build cities for your little ones and folds for your flocks, but do what you have promised." [25] The Gadites and Reubenites said to Moses, "Your servants will do just as our lord commands." [26] Our children, our wives, our livestock, and all our animals will remain here in the cities of Gilead. [27] "But your servants are equipped for war, and every man will cross over to the battle before the LORD, just as our lord says."

[28] So Moses gave orders about them to Eleazar the priest, to Joshua son of Nun, and to the family leaders of the tribes of Israel. [29] And Moses said to them, "If the Gadites and Reubenites cross the Jordan with you, with every man armed for battle before the LORD, and the land is subdued before you, then you are to give them the land of Gilead as a possession." [30] "But if they do not arm themselves and go across with you, then they must accept their possession among you in the land of Canaan." [31] The Gadites and Reubenites replied, "As the LORD has spoken to your servants, so we will do." [32] "We will cross over into the land of Canaan armed before the LORD, that we may have our inheritance on this side of the Jordan." [33] So Moses gave to the Gadites, to the Reubenites, and to the half-tribe of Manasseh son of Joseph the kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites and the kingdom of Og king of Bashan—the land including its cities and the territory surrounding them. [34] And the Gadites built up Dibon, Ataroth, Aroer, [35] Atroth-shophan, Jazer, Jogbehah, [36] Beth-nimrah, and Beth-haran as fortified cities, and they built folds for their flocks. [37] The Reubenites built up Heshbon, Elealeh, Kiriathaim, [38] as well as Nebo and Baal-meon (whose names were changed), and Sibmah. And they renamed the cities they rebuilt. [39] The descendants of Machir son of Manasseh went to Gilead, captured it, and drove out the Amorites who were there. [40] So Moses gave Gilead to the clan of Machir son of Manasseh, and they settled there. [41] Jair, a descendant of Manasseh, went and captured their villages and called them Havvoth-jair. [42] And Nobah went and captured Kenath and its villages and called it Nobah, after his own name.

33 These are the journeys of the Israelites when they came out of the land of Egypt by their divisions under the leadership of Moses and Aaron. [2] At the LORD's command, Moses recorded the stages of their journey. These are the stages listed by their starting points:

[3] On the fifteenth day of the first month, on the day after the Passover, the Israelites set out from Rameses. They marched out defiantly in full view of all the Egyptians,

[4] who were burying all their firstborn, whom the LORD had struck down among them; for the LORD had executed judgment against their gods.

[5] The Israelites set out from Rameses and camped at Succoth.

[6] They set out from Succoth and camped at Etham, on the edge of the wilderness.

[7] They set out from Etham and turned back to Pi-hahiroth, opposite Baal-zephon, and they camped near Migdol.

[8] They set out from Pi-hahiroth and crossed through the sea, into the wilderness, and they journeyed three days into the Wilderness of Etham and camped at Marah.

[9] They set out from Marah and came to Elim, where there were twelve springs and seventy palm trees, and they camped there.

[10] They set out from Elim and camped by the Red Sea.

[11] They set out from the Red Sea and camped in the Desert of Sin.

[12] They set out from the Desert of Sin and camped at Dophkah.

[13] They set out from Dophkah and camped at Alush.

[14] They set out from Alush and camped at Rephidim, where there was no water for the people to drink.

[15] They set out from Rephidim and camped in the Wilderness of Sinai.

[16] They set out from the Wilderness of Sinai and camped at Kibroth-hattaavah.

[17] They set out from Kibroth-hattaavah and camped at Hazeroth.

[18] They set out from Hazeroth and camped at Rithmah.

[19] They set out from Rithmah and camped at Rimmon-perez.

[20] They set out from Rimmon-perez and camped at Libnah.

[21] They set out from Libnah and camped at Rissah.

[22] They set out from Rissah and camped at Kehelathah.

[23] They set out from Kehelathah and camped at Mount Shepher.

[24] They set out from Mount Shepher and camped at Haradah.

[25] They set out from Haradah and camped at Makheloth.

[26] They set out from Makheloth and camped at Tahath.

[27] They set out from Tahath and camped at Terah.

[28] They set out from Terah and camped at Mithkah.

[29] They set out from Mithkah and camped at Hashmonah.

[30] They set out from Hashmonah and camped at Moseroth.

[31] They set out from Moseroth and camped at Bene-jaakan.

[32] They set out from Bene-jaakan and camped at Hor-haggidgad.

[33] They set out from Hor-haggidgad and camped at Jotbathah.

[34] They set out from Jotbathah and camped at Abronah.

[35] They set out from Abronah and camped at Ezion-geber.

[36] They set out from Ezion-geber and camped at Kadesh in the Wilderness of Zin.

[37] They set out from Kadesh and camped at Mount Hor, on the outskirts of the land of Edom.

[38] At the LORD's command, Aaron the priest climbed Mount Hor and died there on the first day of the fifth month, in the fortieth year after the Israelites had come out of the land of Egypt.

[39] Aaron was 123 years old when he died on Mount Hor.

[40] Now the Canaanite king of Arad, who lived in the Negev in the land of Canaan, heard that the Israelites were coming.

[41] And the Israelites set out from Mount Hor and camped at Zalmonah.

[42] They set out from Zalmonah and camped at Punon.

[43] They set out from Punon and camped at Oboth.

[44] They set out from Oboth and camped at Iye-abarim on the border of Moab.

[45] They set out from Iyim and camped at Dibon-gad.

[46] They set out from Dibon-gad and camped at Almon-diblathaim.

[47] They set out from Almon-diblathaim and camped in the mountains of Abarim facing Nebo.

[48] They set out from the mountains of Abarim and camped on the plains of Moab by the Jordan across from Jericho.

[49] And there on the plains of Moab they camped by the Jordan, from Beth-jeshimoth to Abel-shittim. [50] On the plains of Moab by the Jordan across from Jericho, the LORD said to Moses, [51] "Speak to the Israelites and tell them: When you cross the Jordan into the land of Canaan," [52] you must drive out before you all the inhabitants of the land, destroy all their carved images and cast idols, and demolish all their high places. [53] You are to take possession of the land and settle in it, for I have given you the land to possess. [54] And you are to divide the land by lot according to your clans. Give a larger inheritance to a larger clan and a smaller inheritance to a smaller one. Whatever falls to each one by lot will be his. You will receive an inheritance according to the tribes of your fathers. [55] But if you do not drive out the inhabitants of the land before you, those you allow to remain will become barbs in your eyes and thorns in your sides; they will harass you in the land where you settle. [56] "And then I will do to you what I had planned to do to them."

34 Then the LORD said to Moses, [2] "Command the Israelites and say to them: When you enter the land of Canaan, it will be allotted to you as an inheritance with these boundaries:" [3] Your southern border will extend from the Wilderness of Zin along the border of Edom. On the east, your southern border will run from the end of the Salt Sea, [4] cross south of the Ascent of Akrabbim, continue to Zin, and go south of Kadesh-barnea. Then it will go on to Hazar-addar and proceed to Azmon, [5] where it will turn from Azmon, join the Brook of Egypt, and end at the Sea. [6] Your western border will be the coastline of the Great Sea; this will be your boundary on the west. [7] Your northern border will run from the Great Sea directly to Mount Hor, [8] and from Mount Hor to Lebo-hamath, then extend to Zedad, [9] continue to Ziphron, and end at Hazar-enan. This will be your boundary on the north. [10] And your eastern border will run straight from Hazar-enan to Shepham, [11] then go down from Shepham to Riblah on the east side of Ain and continue along the slopes east of the Sea of Chinnereth. [12] "Then the border will go down along the Jordan and end at the Salt Sea. This will be your land, defined by its borders on all sides."

[13] So Moses commanded the Israelites, "Apportion this land by lot as an inheritance. The LORD has commanded that it be given to the nine and a half tribes." [14] For the tribes of the Reubenites and Gadites, along with the half-tribe of Manasseh, have already received their inheritance. [15] "These two and a half tribes have received their inheritance across the Jordan from Jericho, toward the sunrise." [16] Then the LORD said to Moses, [17] "These are the names of the men who are to assign the land as an inheritance for you: Eleazar the priest and Joshua son of Nun." [18] Appoint one leader from each tribe to distribute the land.

[19] These are their names: Caleb son of Jephunneh from the tribe of Judah; [20] Shemuel son of Ammihud from the tribe of Simeon; [21] Elidad son of Chislon from the tribe of Benjamin; [22] Bukki son of Jogli, a leader from the tribe of Dan; [23] Hanniel son of Ephod, a leader from the tribe of Manasseh son of Joseph; [24] Kemuel son of Shiphtan, a leader from the tribe of Ephraim; [25] Eli-zaphan son of Parnach, a leader from the tribe of Zebulun; [26] Paltiel son of Azzan, a leader from the tribe of Issachar; [27] Ahihud son of Shelomi, a leader from the tribe of Asher; [28] "and Pedahel son of Ammihud, a leader from the tribe of Naphtali." [29] These are the ones whom the LORD commanded to apportion the inheritance to the Israelites in the land of Canaan.

35 Again the LORD spoke to Moses on the plains of Moab by the Jordan across from Jericho: [2] "Command the Israelites to give, from the inheritance they will possess, cities for the Levites to live in and pasturelands around the cities." [3] The cities will be for them to live in, and the pasturelands will be for their herds, their flocks, and all their other livestock. [4] The pasturelands around the cities you are to give the Levites will extend a thousand cubits from the wall on every side. [5] You are also to measure two thousand cubits outside the city on the east, two thousand on the south, two thousand on the west, and two thousand on the north, with the city in the center. These areas will serve as larger pasturelands for the cities. [6] Six of the cities you give the Levites are to be appointed as cities of refuge, to which a manslayer may flee. In addition to these, give the Levites forty-two other cities. [7] The total number of cities you give the Levites will be forty-eight, with their corresponding pasturelands. [8] "The cities that you apportion from the territory of the Israelites should be given to the Levites in proportion to the inheritance of each tribe: more from a larger tribe and less from a smaller one." [9] Then the LORD said to Moses, [10] "Speak to the Israelites and tell them: When you cross the Jordan into the land of Canaan," [11] designate cities to serve as your cities of refuge, so that a person who kills someone unintentionally may flee there. [12] You are to have these cities as a refuge from the avenger, so that the manslayer will not die until he stands trial before the assembly. [13] The cities you select will be your six cities of refuge. [14] Select three cities across the Jordan and three in the land of Canaan as cities of refuge.

[15] These six cities will serve as a refuge for the Israelites and for the foreigner or stranger among them, so that anyone who kills a person unintentionally may flee there. [16] If, however, anyone strikes a person with an iron object and kills him, he is a murderer; the murderer must surely be put to death. [17] Or if anyone has in his hand a stone of deadly size, and he strikes and kills another, he is a murderer; the murderer must surely be put to death. [18] If anyone has in his hand a deadly object of wood, and he strikes and kills another, he is a murderer; the murderer must surely be put to death. [19] The avenger of blood is to put the murderer to death; when he finds him, he is to kill him. [20] Likewise, if anyone maliciously pushes another or intentionally throws an object at him and kills him, [21] or if in hostility he strikes him with his hand and he dies, the one who struck him must surely be put to death; he is a murderer. When the avenger of blood finds the murderer, he is to kill him.

[22] But if anyone pushes a person suddenly, without hostility, or throws an object at him unintentionally, [23] or without looking drops a heavy stone that kills him, but he was not an enemy and did not intend to harm him, [24] then the congregation must judge between the slayer and the avenger of blood according to these ordinances. [25] The assembly is to protect the manslayer from the hand of the avenger of blood. Then the assembly will return him to the city of refuge to which he fled, and he must live there until the death of the high priest, who was anointed with the holy oil. [26] But if the manslayer ever goes outside the limits of the city of refuge to which he fled [27] and the avenger of blood finds him outside of his city of refuge and kills him, then the avenger will not be guilty of bloodshed [28] because the manslayer must remain in his city of refuge until the death of the high priest. Only after the death of the high priest may he return to the land he owns. [29] This will be a statutory ordinance for you for the generations to come, wherever you live. [30] If anyone kills a person, the murderer is to be put to death on the testimony of the witnesses. But no one is to be put to death based on the testimony of a lone witness. [31] You are not to accept a ransom for the life of a murderer who deserves to die; he must surely be put to death. [32] Nor should you accept a ransom for the person who flees to a city of refuge and allow him to return and live on his own land before the death of the high priest. [33] Do not pollute the land where you live, for bloodshed pollutes the land, and no atonement can be made for the land on which the blood is shed, except by the blood of the one who shed it. [34] "Do not defile the land where you live and where I dwell. For I, the LORD, dwell among the Israelites."

36 Now the family heads of the clan of Gilead son of Machir son of Manasseh, one of the clans of Joseph, approached Moses and the leaders who were the heads of the Israelite families and addressed them, [2] saying, "When the LORD commanded my lord to give the land as an inheritance to the Israelites by lot, He also commanded him to give the inheritance of our brother Zelophehad to his daughters." [3] But if they marry any of the men from the other tribes of Israel, their inheritance will be withdrawn from the portion of our fathers and added to the tribe into which they marry. So our allotted inheritance would be taken away. [4] "And when the Jubilee for the Israelites comes, their inheritance will be added to the tribe into which they marry and taken away from the tribe of our fathers." [5] So at the word of the LORD, Moses commanded the Israelites: "The tribe of the sons of Joseph speaks correctly." [6] This is what the LORD has commanded concerning the daughters of Zelophehad: They may marry anyone they please, provided they marry within a clan of the tribe of their father. [7] No inheritance in Israel may be transferred from tribe to tribe, because each of the Israelites is to retain the inheritance of the tribe of his fathers. [8] Every daughter who possesses an inheritance from any Israelite tribe must marry within a clan of the tribe of her father, so that every Israelite will possess the inheritance of his fathers. [9] "No inheritance may be transferred from one tribe to another, for each tribe of Israel must retain its inheritance." [10] So the daughters of Zelophehad did as the LORD had commanded Moses. [11] Mahlah, Tirzah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Noah, the daughters of Zelophehad, were married to cousins on their father's side. [12] They married within the clans of the descendants of Manasseh son of Joseph, and their inheritance remained within the tribe of their father's clan. [13] These are the commandments and ordinances that the LORD gave the Israelites through Moses on the plains of Moab by the Jordan across from Jericho.

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